

# Education, Child Marriage, and Heterogeneous Wage Returns among Women in Nigeria

## Results

Hernando Grueso, Ritapriya Bandyopadhyay, Chris Desmond, Brendan  
Maughan-Brown, Lucie Cluver, William Rudgard

25/08/2026

Early marriage remains widespread in Northern Nigeria and may constrain women's economic gains from schooling. Using the 2018–19 Nigeria Living Standards Survey ( $n=2,387$  wage earners nationally;  $n=932$  in Northern Nigeria), we estimate Mincerian wage models with state fixed effects, Heckman selection correction, and causal forests.

Each additional year of schooling raises wages by  $\sim 15\%$  in both samples, with convex returns. Child marriage (before 18) is associated with a  $14.4\%$  wage penalty nationally ( $12\%$  prevalence) and  $23.6\%$  in Northern Nigeria ( $23\%$  prevalence).

Nationally, the interaction is significant ( $p < 0.001$ ): child marriage reduces both wage levels and returns to education. In Northern Nigeria, child marriage operates as a pure level shift (interaction  $p = 0.459$ ).

## Whole Country (12% prevalence)

- ▶ Significant interaction ( $p < 0.001$ )
- ▶ Child marriage = level shift + reduces returns
- ▶ Returns: 7–9% (married) vs 4–14% (unmarried)
- ▶ Variable importance: 6.8%

## Northern Nigeria (23% prevalence)

- ▶ No interaction ( $p = 0.459$ )
- ▶ Child marriage = pure level shift
- ▶ Returns stay ~15% regardless of marriage age
- ▶ Variable importance: only 4.9%

1. Each year of schooling raises wages by  $\sim 15\%$ , and child marriage lowers wage levels by  $\sim 15\%$ . In Northern Nigeria, these effects are additive: policies must scale up schooling and delay marriage in parallel.
2. Northern Nigeria's child marriage prevalence (23%) and wage penalty ( $\sim 15\%$ ) are roughly double the national averages.
3. In high-prevalence settings, the penalty likely reflects broad social constraints (fertility timing, mobility limits, norms), calling for community-wide and cash-plus approaches.

# Descriptive Statistics

Table 1: Descriptive Statistics (Wage Earners)

Table 1: Descriptive Statistics – Wage Earners

| Variable                   | National (N=2,387) | N. Nigeria (N=932) |
|----------------------------|--------------------|--------------------|
| Continuous: Mean (SD)      |                    |                    |
| Log annual wage            | 12.02 (1.42)       | 11.83 (1.60)       |
| Years of schooling         | 14.42 (5.81)       | 13.06 (7.02)       |
| Age                        | 36.69 (11.03)      | 36.34 (10.85)      |
| Experience                 | 16.01 (12.13)      | 16.65 (11.91)      |
| Binary (%)                 |                    |                    |
| Child marriage (%)         | 11.7               | 23.1               |
| Rural (%)                  | 49.9               | 56.3               |
| Literate (%)               | 86.1               | 78.9               |
| Currently married (%)      | 61.0               | 70.7               |
| Religion (%)               |                    |                    |
| Religion: Islam (%)        | 76.5               | 53.1               |
| Religion: Christianity (%) | 23.0               | 46.8               |
| Religion: Other (%)        | 0.5                | 0.1                |
| Father education (%)       |                    |                    |
| Father edu: None (%)       | 33.6               | 38.1               |
| Father edu: Primary (%)    | 43.6               | 28.2               |
| Father edu: Secondary+ (%) | 22.8               | 33.7               |
| Mother education (%)       |                    |                    |
| Mother edu: None (%)       | 45.1               | 51.2               |
| Mother edu: Primary (%)    | 40.9               | 28.2               |
| Mother edu: Secondary+ (%) | 14.0               | 20.6               |
| Sector (%)                 |                    |                    |
| Sector: Urban (%)          | 50.1               | 43.7               |
| Sector: Rural (%)          | 49.9               | 56.3               |
| N                          | 2,387              | 932                |

Note: Source: NLSS 2018-19. Women aged 18-64 in wage employment. Survey weights applied. Continuous variables: Mean (SD).

## National Results

Table 2: Sample Construction – National

| Step | Description                  | N      | N_dropped |
|------|------------------------------|--------|-----------|
| 0    | Full Whole Country dataset   | 27,488 | 0         |
| 1    | Women only                   | 27,488 | 0         |
| 2    | Age 18-64 (working age)      | 27,488 | 0         |
| 3    | Non-missing key variables    | 26,450 | 1,038     |
| 4    | Workers with valid wage data | 2,387  | 24,063    |



Table 2: National – Quadratic Mincer

Table 3: National – Quadratic Mincer

|                                 | Basic                | + Controls           | + State FE           | + Interaction        | Heckman              |
|---------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| Years of Schooling              | 0.116***<br>(0.006)  | 0.111***<br>(0.006)  | 0.089***<br>(0.007)  | 0.082***<br>(0.008)  | 0.077***<br>(0.003)  |
| Years of Schooling <sup>2</sup> | 0.007***<br>(0.001)  | 0.007***<br>(0.001)  | 0.008***<br>(0.001)  | 0.009***<br>(0.001)  | 0.009***<br>(0.000)  |
| Experience                      | 0.042***<br>(0.002)  | 0.043***<br>(0.002)  | 0.040***<br>(0.002)  | 0.040***<br>(0.002)  | 0.020***<br>(0.001)  |
| Experience <sup>2</sup>         | -0.001***<br>(0.000) | -0.001***<br>(0.000) | -0.001***<br>(0.000) | -0.001***<br>(0.000) | -0.001***<br>(0.000) |
| Child Marriage                  | -0.314***<br>(0.081) | -0.263***<br>(0.081) | -0.078<br>(0.084)    | -0.144<br>(0.091)    |                      |
| Years × Child Marriage          |                      |                      |                      | 0.022*<br>(0.011)    |                      |
| Rural                           |                      | -0.261***<br>(0.044) | -0.145***<br>(0.048) | -0.142***<br>(0.048) |                      |
| Inv. Mills Ratio ( )            |                      |                      |                      |                      | 0.822**<br>(0.361)   |
| Currently Married               |                      | -0.098**<br>(0.047)  | -0.035<br>(0.046)    | -0.035<br>(0.046)    |                      |
| Observations                    | 2387                 | 2387                 | 2387                 | 2387                 | 26 432               |
| R <sup>2</sup>                  | 0.403                | 0.412                | 0.479                | 0.480                |                      |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup>             | 0.402                | 0.411                | 0.470                | 0.470                |                      |
| Residual Std. Error             |                      |                      |                      |                      | 1.222                |
| State FE                        | No                   | No                   | Yes                  | Yes                  | Yes                  |
| Controls                        | No                   | Yes                  | Yes                  | Yes                  | Yes                  |
| Interaction                     | No                   | No                   | No                   | Yes                  | No                   |
| Selection Correction            | No                   | No                   | No                   | No                   | Yes                  |

\* p &lt; 0.1, \*\* p &lt; 0.05, \*\*\* p &lt; 0.01

Note: Source: NLSS 2018-19. Women aged 18-64 in wage employment. Survey weights applied. School-

Table 4: National – Linear Specification

|                        | Basic               | + Controls           | + State FE           | + Interaction        |
|------------------------|---------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| Years of Schooling     | 0.169***<br>(0.005) | 0.163***<br>(0.005)  | 0.152***<br>(0.005)  | 0.156***<br>(0.006)  |
| Experience             | 0.047***<br>(0.002) | 0.046***<br>(0.002)  | 0.044***<br>(0.002)  | 0.045***<br>(0.002)  |
| Child Marriage         | -0.120<br>(0.083)   | -0.087<br>(0.083)    | 0.031<br>(0.087)     | 0.314**<br>(0.154)   |
| Years × Child Marriage |                     |                      |                      | -0.025**<br>(0.011)  |
| Rural                  |                     | -0.270***<br>(0.046) | -0.181***<br>(0.050) | -0.182***<br>(0.050) |
| State FE               | No                  | No                   | Yes                  | Yes                  |
| Controls               | No                  | Yes                  | Yes                  | Yes                  |
| Interaction            | No                  | No                   | No                   | Yes                  |
| Currently Married      |                     | 0.087*<br>(0.046)    | 0.140***<br>(0.045)  | 0.135***<br>(0.046)  |
| Observations           | 2387                | 2387                 | 2387                 | 2387                 |
| R <sup>2</sup>         | 0.362               | 0.372                | 0.433                | 0.434                |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup>    | 0.361               | 0.371                | 0.423                | 0.424                |

\* p < 0.1, \*\* p < 0.05, \*\*\* p < 0.01

Note: Source: NLSS 2018-19. Women aged 18-64 in wage employment. Survey weights applied.

Table 5: Returns by Education Level – National

|                | By Level             |
|----------------|----------------------|
| Primary        | 0.205<br>(0.216)     |
| Secondary      | 0.309**<br>(0.122)   |
| Higher Ed      | 1.558***<br>(0.122)  |
| Experience     | 0.041***<br>(0.002)  |
| Experience Sq. | −0.001***<br>(0.000) |
| Child Marriage | −0.167*<br>(0.093)   |
| N              | 2387                 |
| R2             | 0.369                |

\*  $p < 0.1$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$

Note:

Omitted: No education. State FE, rural, marital controls included.

Table 6: Returns to Literacy – National

|                | Literacy             |
|----------------|----------------------|
| Literate       | 1.159***<br>(0.089)  |
| Experience     | 0.029***<br>(0.002)  |
| Experience Sq. | −0.001***<br>(0.000) |
| Child Marriage | −0.242**<br>(0.095)  |
| N              | 2387                 |
| R2             | 0.323                |

\*  $p < 0.1$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$

Note: State FE, rural, marital controls included. Source: NLSS 2018-19. Women aged 18-64 in wage employment. Survey weights applied. Schooling and experience are mean-centred.

Table 7: Probit: Pr(Wage Employment) – National

|                    | Pr(Wage Work)        |
|--------------------|----------------------|
| Years of Schooling | 0.076***<br>(0.003)  |
| Years Sq.          | 0.009***<br>(0.000)  |
| Experience         | 0.020***<br>(0.001)  |
| Experience Sq.     | −0.001***<br>(0.000) |
| Child Marriage     | −0.123***<br>(0.040) |
| Rural              | −0.158***<br>(0.029) |
| Observations       | 26 450               |
| State FE           | Yes                  |
| Parent Education   | Yes                  |

\*  $p < 0.1$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$

Note: Source: NLSS 2018-19. All women aged 18-64 with non-missing covariates. Probit includes schooling (+ sq.), experience (+ sq.), child marriage, urban/rural, parental education (factors), and state FE.

Table 8: Average Marginal Effects on  $\Pr(\text{Wage Work})$  – National

| Variable               | AME     | SE     | p       |
|------------------------|---------|--------|---------|
| Child Marriage         | -0.0153 | 0.0048 | 0.001   |
| Experience             | 0.0025  | 0.0002 | < 0.001 |
| Experience Sq.         | -0.0001 | 0.0000 | < 0.001 |
| Rural                  | -0.0209 | 0.0040 | < 0.001 |
| Years of Schooling     | 0.0098  | 0.0004 | < 0.001 |
| Years of Schooling Sq. | 0.0011  | 0.0000 | < 0.001 |

Note: Source: NLSS 2018-19. All women aged 18-64 with non-missing covariates. Probit includes schooling (+ sq.), experience (+ sq.), child marriage, urban/rural, parental education (factors), and state FE. AME via `marginaleffects` package.

## Table 8: Causal Forest – National

### Average Return to Education

Table 9: CF: Average Treatment Effect – National

| Term                        | Estimate | Std. Error | t stat | p value |
|-----------------------------|----------|------------|--------|---------|
| Education Return (per year) | 0.155    | 0.017      | 9.346  | 0       |

Outcome: Log Annual Wage. Treatment: Years of Schooling. 4,000 trees.

### Test for Heterogeneity

Table 10: CF Calibration Test – National

| Term                           | Estimate | Std. Error | t stat | p value |
|--------------------------------|----------|------------|--------|---------|
| Mean Forest Prediction         | 1.045    | 0.184      | 5.678  | 0.00    |
| Differential Forest Prediction | 0.668    | 0.355      | 1.880  | 0.03    |

### Variable Importance

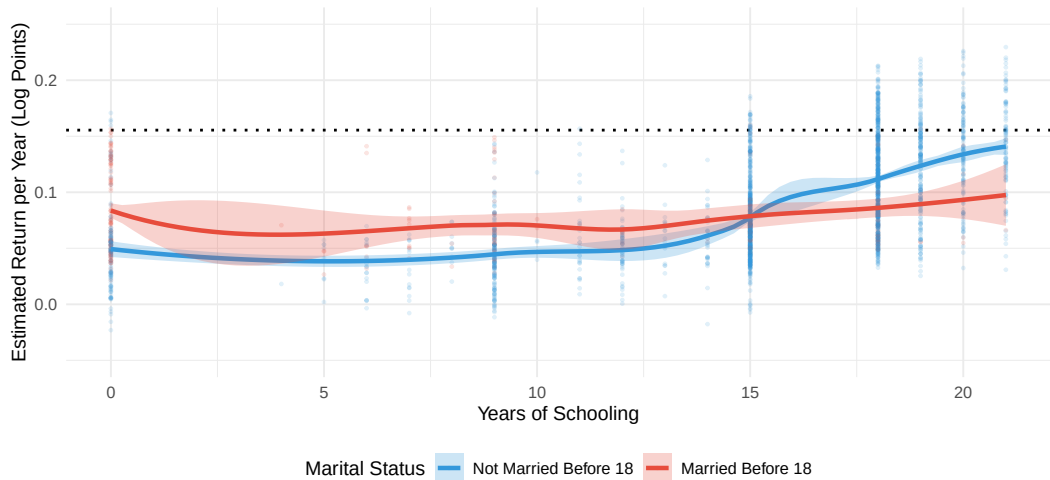
Table 11: CF Variable Importance – National

| Variable           | Importance |
|--------------------|------------|
| Experience         | 0.319      |
| Mother's Education | 0.230      |
| Age                | 0.229      |
| Father's Education | 0.126      |
| Child Marriage     | 0.064      |
| Rural              | 0.032      |

# Figure 1: Heterogeneous Returns – National

**Figure 1: Heterogeneous Returns to Education -- National**

Causal Forest Estimates by Child Marriage Status



Dotted line = Average Return (0.155)



Figure 2: Distribution of Returns – National

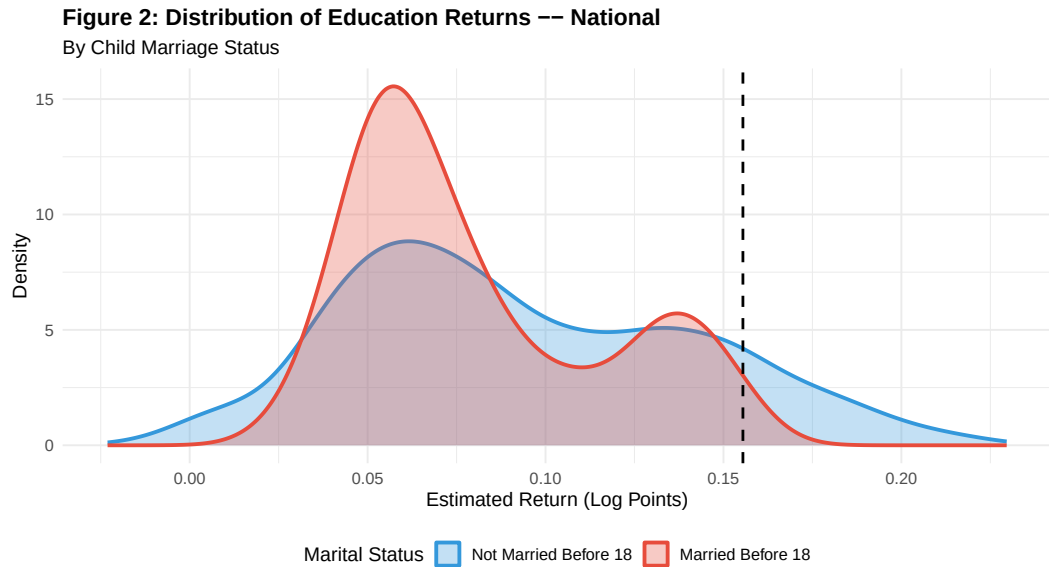
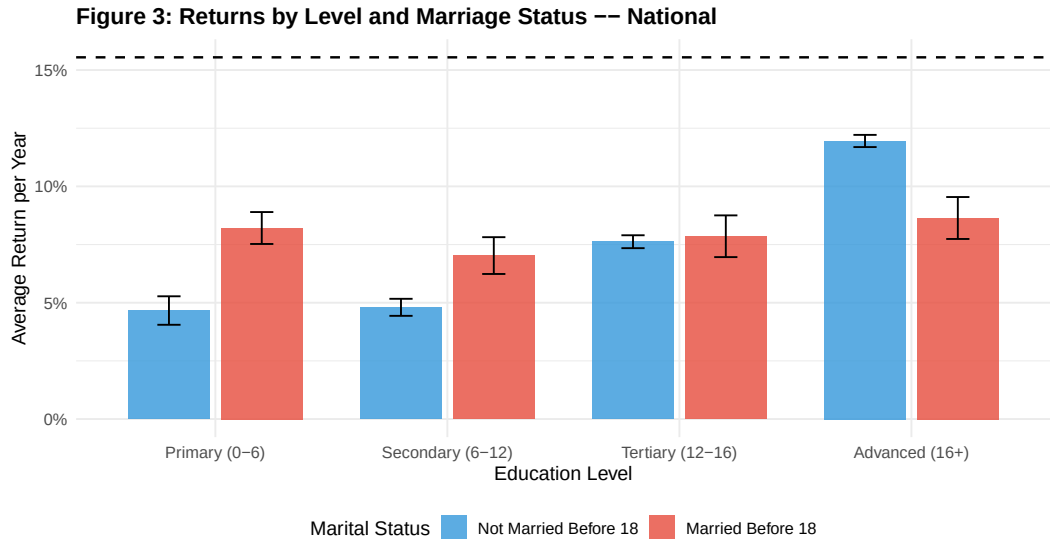
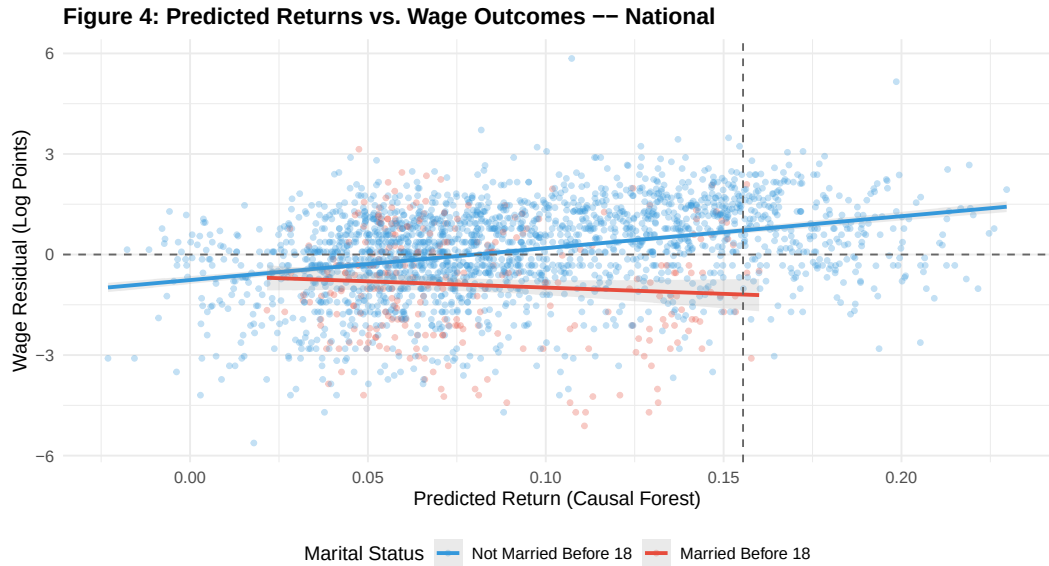


Figure 3: Returns by Level and Marriage – National



Dashed line = overall average. Error bars = 95% CIs.

Figure 4: Validation – National



## Northern Nigeria

Table 12: Sample Construction – Northern Nigeria

| Step | Description                   | N      | N_dropped |
|------|-------------------------------|--------|-----------|
| 0    | Full Northern Nigeria dataset | 16,611 | 0         |
| 1    | Women only                    | 16,611 | 0         |
| 2    | Age 18-64 (working age)       | 16,611 | 0         |
| 3    | Non-missing key variables     | 16,140 | 471       |
| 4    | Workers with valid wage data  | 932    | 15,208    |

Table 13: Northern Nigeria – Quadratic Mincer

|                                 | Basic                | + Controls           | + State FE           | + Interaction        | Heckman              |
|---------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| Years of Schooling              | 0.071***<br>(0.011)  | 0.066***<br>(0.011)  | 0.053***<br>(0.011)  | 0.043***<br>(0.013)  | 0.048***<br>(0.005)  |
| Years of Schooling <sup>2</sup> | 0.012***<br>(0.001)  | 0.012***<br>(0.001)  | 0.011***<br>(0.001)  | 0.011***<br>(0.001)  | 0.009***<br>(0.001)  |
| Experience                      | 0.042***<br>(0.003)  | 0.041***<br>(0.003)  | 0.040***<br>(0.003)  | 0.039***<br>(0.003)  | 0.026***<br>(0.002)  |
| Experience <sup>2</sup>         | -0.001***<br>(0.000) | -0.001***<br>(0.000) | -0.001***<br>(0.000) | -0.001***<br>(0.000) | -0.001***<br>(0.000) |
| Child Marriage                  | -0.262***<br>(0.094) | -0.237**<br>(0.094)  | -0.150<br>(0.096)    | -0.236**<br>(0.113)  |                      |
| Years × Child Marriage          |                      |                      |                      | 0.017<br>(0.012)     |                      |
| Rural                           |                      | -0.253***<br>(0.074) | -0.130*<br>(0.073)   | -0.123*<br>(0.073)   |                      |
| Inv. Mills Ratio ( )            |                      |                      |                      |                      | 0.217<br>(0.420)     |
| Currently Married               |                      | -0.187**<br>(0.080)  | -0.123<br>(0.078)    | -0.113<br>(0.079)    |                      |
| Observations                    | 932                  | 932                  | 932                  | 932                  | 16 130               |
| R <sup>2</sup>                  | 0.540                | 0.548                | 0.605                | 0.606                |                      |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup>             | 0.537                | 0.544                | 0.594                | 0.594                |                      |
| Residual Std. Error             |                      |                      |                      |                      | 1.021                |
| State FE                        | No                   | No                   | Yes                  | Yes                  | Yes                  |
| Controls                        | No                   | Yes                  | Yes                  | Yes                  | Yes                  |
| Interaction                     | No                   | No                   | No                   | Yes                  | No                   |
| Selection Correction            | No                   | No                   | No                   | No                   | Yes                  |

\* p &lt; 0.1, \*\* p &lt; 0.05, \*\*\* p &lt; 0.01

Note: Source: NLSS 2018-19. Women aged 18-64 in wage employment. Survey weights applied. School-

Table 14: Northern Nigeria – Linear Specification

|                        | Basic               | + Controls           | + State FE          | + Interaction        |
|------------------------|---------------------|----------------------|---------------------|----------------------|
| Years of Schooling     | 0.172***<br>(0.007) | 0.166***<br>(0.007)  | 0.149***<br>(0.007) | 0.155***<br>(0.009)  |
| Experience             | 0.047***<br>(0.004) | 0.046***<br>(0.004)  | 0.045***<br>(0.003) | 0.045***<br>(0.003)  |
| Child Marriage         | -0.142<br>(0.102)   | -0.112<br>(0.101)    | -0.044<br>(0.103)   | 0.148<br>(0.170)     |
| Years × Child Marriage |                     |                      |                     | -0.018<br>(0.013)    |
| Rural                  |                     | -0.338***<br>(0.080) | -0.202**<br>(0.079) | -0.207***<br>(0.079) |
| State FE               | No                  | No                   | Yes                 | Yes                  |
| Controls               | No                  | Yes                  | Yes                 | Yes                  |
| Interaction            | No                  | No                   | No                  | Yes                  |
| Currently Married      |                     | 0.041<br>(0.082)     | 0.060<br>(0.081)    | 0.050<br>(0.081)     |
| Observations           | 932                 | 932                  | 932                 | 932                  |
| R <sup>2</sup>         | 0.459               | 0.470                | 0.539               | 0.540                |
| Adj. R <sup>2</sup>    | 0.457               | 0.467                | 0.527               | 0.527                |

\* p < 0.1, \*\* p < 0.05, \*\*\* p < 0.01

Note: Source: NLSS 2018-19. Women aged 18-64 in wage employment. Survey weights applied.

Table 15: Returns by Education Level – N. Nigeria

|                | By Level             |
|----------------|----------------------|
| Primary        | −0.319<br>(0.351)    |
| Secondary      | 0.215<br>(0.150)     |
| Higher Ed      | 1.912***<br>(0.139)  |
| Experience     | 0.044***<br>(0.004)  |
| Experience Sq. | −0.002***<br>(0.000) |
| Child Marriage | −0.190*<br>(0.105)   |
| N              | 932                  |
| R2             | 0.521                |

\*  $p < 0.1$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$

Note:

Omitted: No education. State  
FE, rural, marital controls included.



Table 16: Returns to Literacy – N. Nigeria

|                | Literacy             |
|----------------|----------------------|
| Literate       | 1.529***<br>(0.119)  |
| Experience     | 0.035***<br>(0.004)  |
| Experience Sq. | −0.002***<br>(0.000) |
| Child Marriage | −0.309***<br>(0.110) |
| N              | 932                  |
| R2             | 0.461                |

\*  $p < 0.1$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$

Note: State FE, rural, marital controls included. Source: NLSS 2018-19. Women aged 18-64 in wage employment. Survey weights applied. Schooling and experience are mean-centred.

Table 17: Probit: Pr(Wage Employment) – N. Nigeria

|                    | Pr(Wage Work)        |
|--------------------|----------------------|
| Years of Schooling | 0.047***<br>(0.005)  |
| Years Sq.          | 0.009***<br>(0.001)  |
| Experience         | 0.026***<br>(0.002)  |
| Experience Sq.     | −0.001***<br>(0.000) |
| Child Marriage     | −0.094*<br>(0.050)   |
| Rural              | −0.111**<br>(0.044)  |
| Observations       | 16 140               |
| State FE           | Yes                  |
| Parent Education   | Yes                  |

\*  $p < 0.1$ , \*\*  $p < 0.05$ , \*\*\*  $p < 0.01$

Note: Source: NLSS 2018-19. All women aged 18-64 with non-missing covariates. Probit includes schooling (+ sq.), experience (+ sq.), child marriage, urban/rural, parental education (factors), and state FE.

Table 18: Average Marginal Effects on Pr(Wage Work) – N. Nigeria

| Variable               | AME     | SE     | p       |
|------------------------|---------|--------|---------|
| Child Marriage         | -0.0080 | 0.0042 | 0.056   |
| Experience             | 0.0023  | 0.0002 | < 0.001 |
| Experience Sq.         | -0.0001 | 0.0000 | < 0.001 |
| Rural                  | -0.0099 | 0.0041 | 0.015   |
| Years of Schooling     | 0.0041  | 0.0004 | < 0.001 |
| Years of Schooling Sq. | 0.0008  | 0.0001 | < 0.001 |

Note: Source: NLSS 2018-19. All women aged 18-64 with non-missing covariates. Probit includes schooling (+ sq.), experience (+ sq.), child marriage, urban/rural, parental education (factors), and state FE. AME via `marginaleffects` package.

## Table 15: Causal Forest – N. Nigeria

### Average Return to Education

Table 19: CF: Average Treatment Effect – N. Nigeria

| Term                        | Estimate | Std. Error | t stat | p value |
|-----------------------------|----------|------------|--------|---------|
| Education Return (per year) | 0.149    | 0.016      | 9.389  | 0       |

Outcome: Log Annual Wage. Treatment: Years of Schooling. 4,000 trees.

### Test for Heterogeneity

Table 20: CF Calibration Test – N. Nigeria

| Term                           | Estimate | Std. Error | t stat | p value |
|--------------------------------|----------|------------|--------|---------|
| Mean Forest Prediction         | 1.055    | 0.163      | 6.461  | 0.000   |
| Differential Forest Prediction | 0.969    | 0.432      | 2.243  | 0.013   |

### Variable Importance

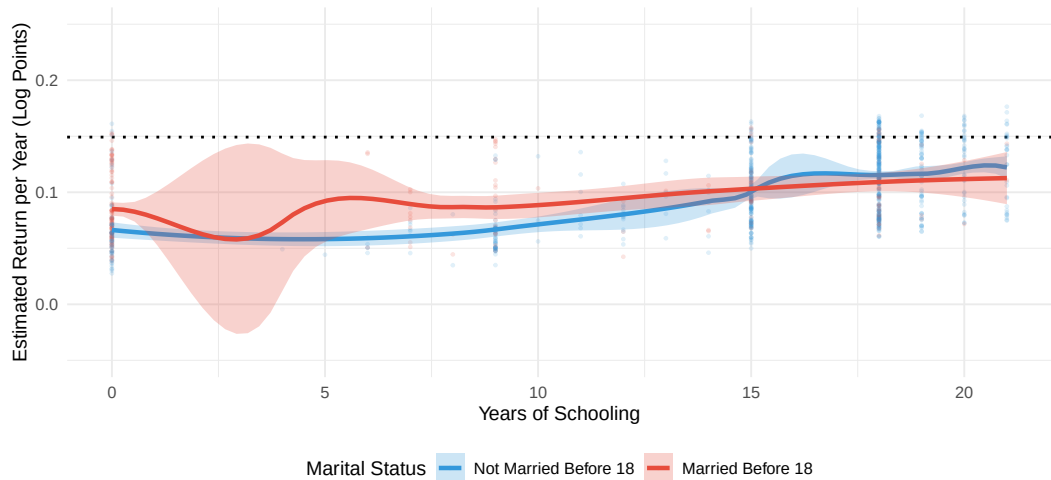
Table 21: CF Variable Importance – N. Nigeria

| Variable           | Importance |
|--------------------|------------|
| Experience         | 0.380      |
| Age                | 0.250      |
| Mother's Education | 0.161      |
| Father's Education | 0.126      |
| Child Marriage     | 0.046      |
| Rural              | 0.037      |

Figure 5: Heterogeneous Returns – N. Nigeria

**Figure 5: Heterogeneous Returns to Education -- N. Nigeria**

Causal Forest Estimates by Child Marriage Status



Dotted line = Average Return (0.149)

Figure 6: Distribution of Returns – N. Nigeria

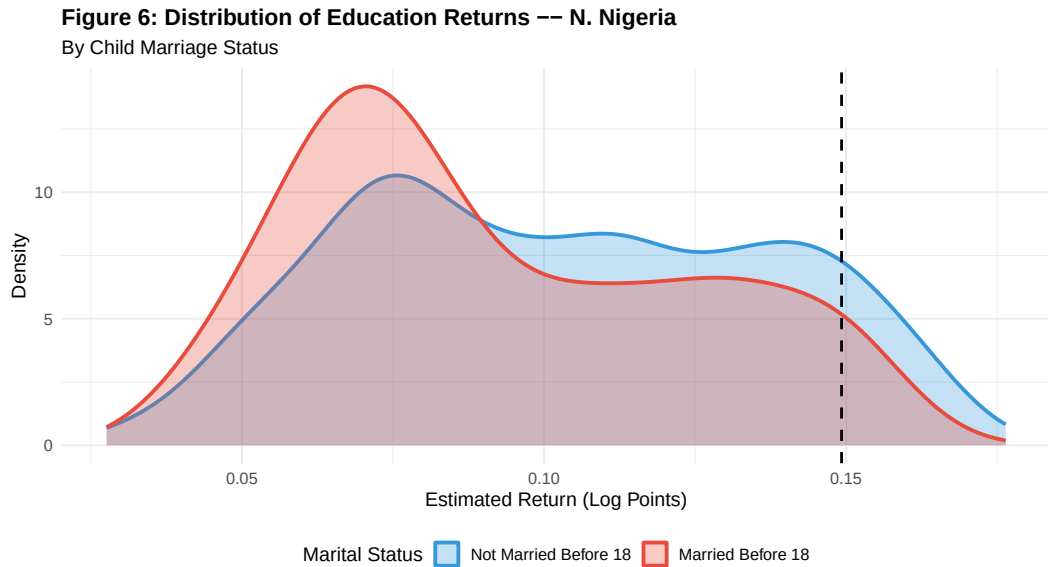
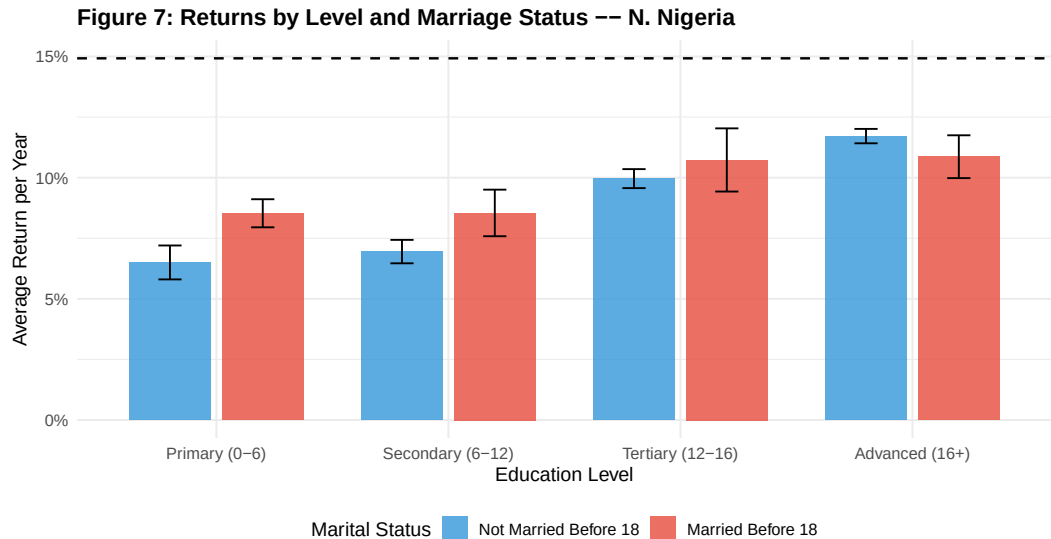
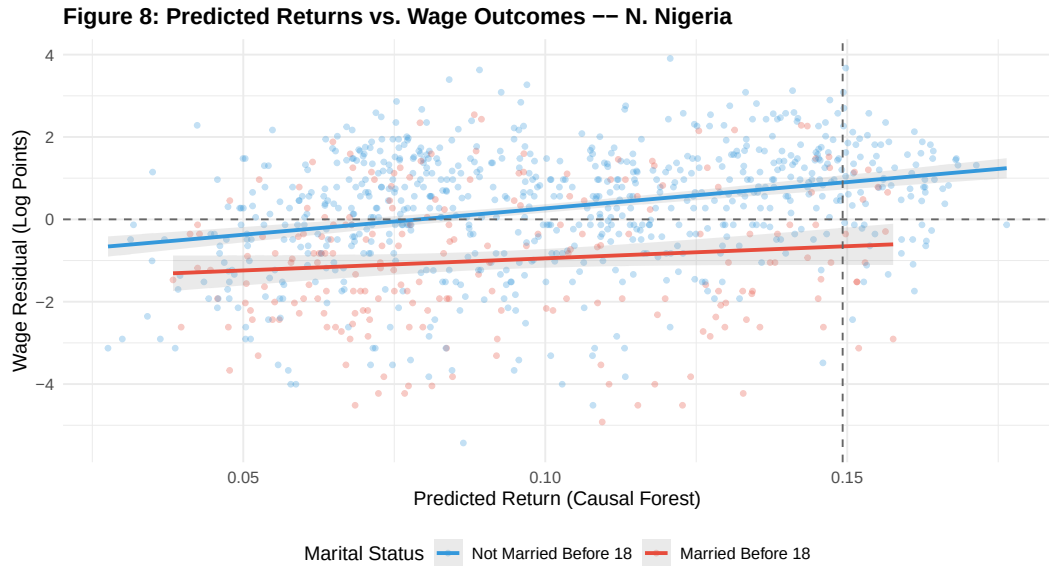


Figure 7: Returns by Level and Marriage – N. Nigeria



Dashed line = overall average. Error bars = 95% CIs.

Figure 8: Validation – N. Nigeria



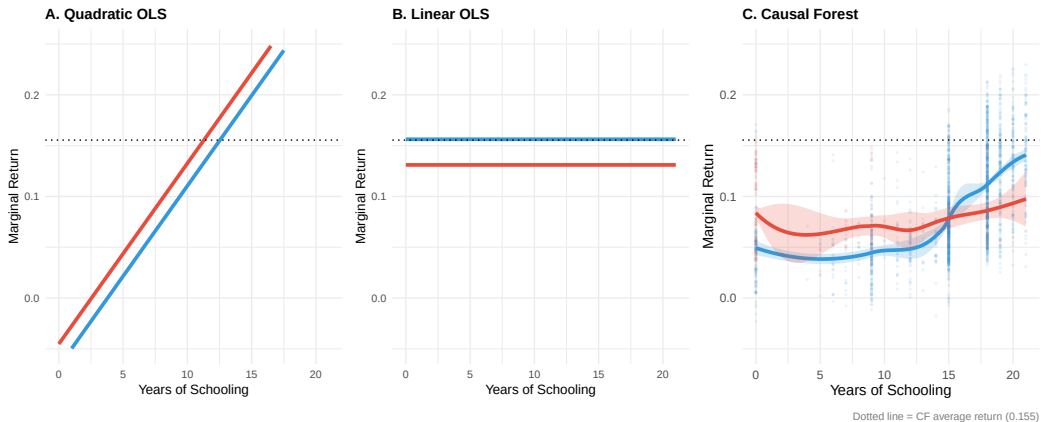


## Cross-Region Comparison

# Figure 9: Returns Across Methods – National

**Figure 9: Returns Across Methods -- National**

Blue = Not married before 18; Red = Married before 18



# Figure 10: Returns Across Methods – N. Nigeria

**Figure 10: Returns Across Methods -- N. Nigeria**

Blue = Not married before 18; Red = Married before 18

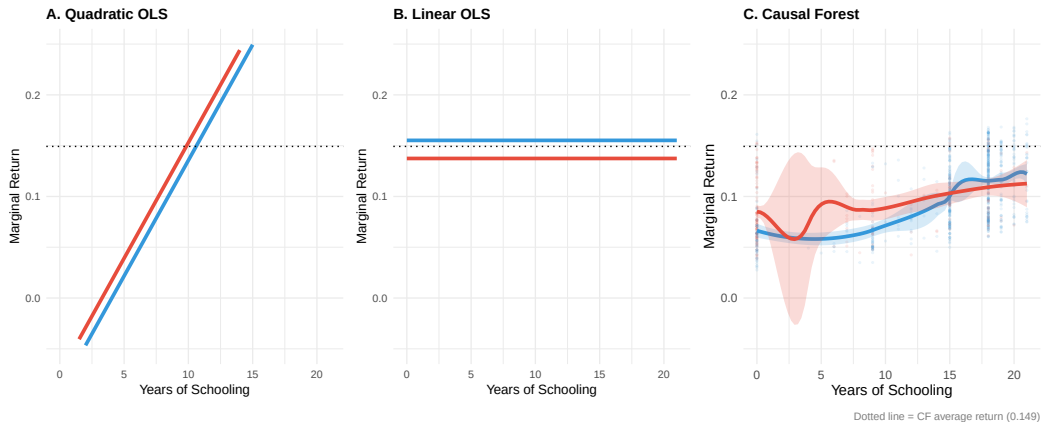


Table 22: Key Estimates – National vs. Northern Nigeria

| Metric                              | National | N. Nigeria   |
|-------------------------------------|----------|--------------|
| Average Return (CF)                 | 15.5%    | 14.9%        |
| Return Std. Error                   | 0.017    | 0.016        |
| Child Marriage Penalty (OLS+FE)     | -7.8%    | -15.0%       |
| Interaction: Years x Child Marriage | 0.022    | 0.017        |
| Interaction p-value                 | 0.054    | 0.155        |
| Child Marriage Var. Importance (CF) | 6.4%     | 4.6%         |
| Heckman lambda                      | 0.822**  | 0.217 (n.s.) |
| N (wage earners)                    | 2,387    | 932          |
| N (selection sample)                | 26,450   | 16,140       |

Note: Source: NLSS 2018-19. CF = Causal Forest. OLS+FE = OLS with state fixed effects.

# Appendix

Table 23: Descriptive Statistics – Full Working-Age Sample

| Variable                   | National (N=26,450) | N. Nigeria (N=16,140) |
|----------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------|
| Continuous: Mean (SD)      |                     |                       |
| Log annual wage            | 12.02 (1.42)        | 11.83 (1.60)          |
| Years of schooling         | 8.37 (7.07)         | 5.90 (6.92)           |
| Age                        | 34.57 (12.26)       | 33.50 (11.69)         |
| Experience                 | 18.90 (14.26)       | 19.58 (13.69)         |
| Binary (%)                 |                     |                       |
| Child marriage (%)         | 31.6                | 46.2                  |
| Rural (%)                  | 70.6                | 77.9                  |
| Literate (%)               | 59.7                | 47.5                  |
| Currently married (%)      | 69.3                | 78.4                  |
| Religion (%)               |                     |                       |
| Religion: Islam (%)        | 51.6                | 28.3                  |
| Religion: Christianity (%) | 47.8                | 71.2                  |
| Religion: Other (%)        | 0.7                 | 0.5                   |
| Father education (%)       |                     |                       |
| Father edu: None (%)       | 40.1                | 40.2                  |
| Father edu: Primary (%)    | 29.1                | 16.0                  |
| Father edu: Secondary+ (%) | 30.8                | 43.8                  |
| Mother education (%)       |                     |                       |
| Mother edu: None (%)       | 50.6                | 51.3                  |
| Mother edu: Primary (%)    | 25.3                | 13.1                  |
| Mother edu: Secondary+ (%) | 24.1                | 35.5                  |
| Sector (%)                 |                     |                       |
| Sector: Urban (%)          | 29.4                | 22.1                  |
| Sector: Rural (%)          | 70.6                | 77.9                  |
| Labour market (%)          |                     |                       |
| Wage employment (%)        | 8.7                 | 5.6                   |
| N                          | 26,450              | 16,140                |